



Helping Life Happen

Initial temperament/suitability test
for prospective owner-trained assistance dog teams

This test must be carried out by a Pawsable affiliated dog trainer and should take place in a public setting such as a shopping centre, supermarket or garden centre.

- The dog must be happy to be stroked by a friendly stranger. Yes ☐ No ☐
- The dog must be comfortable being examined by the trainer; the dog will be stroked gently and then have its teeth, ears and front feet examined. At this stage it is acceptable for the dog to pull away but must not show any signs of aggression. Yes ☐ No ☐
- The dog must be happy to walk through a crowd, remaining under control and not jumping up or being unduly afraid. Yes ☐ No ☐
- The dog must be comfortable around another dog, with no signs of aggression. Yes ☐ No ☐
- Reacting to distractions, eg a shopping trolley clattering, a clipboard being dropped: the dog can express curiosity or surprise and can be reassured and petted, but must not be panicked, run off or show any aggression, and must recover quickly Yes ☐ No ☐
- Accepting novelty or differences – When coming across an unusual object or somebody behaving or moving in an unexpected manner the dog might be unsure and want to avoid getting too close. This is normal and acceptable, but the dog should be able to relax at a distance and be inquisitive, with the potential to investigate and become accepting with correct handling. Examples might include - someone in a wheelchair or using a walking frame or stick, a crying child in a pram, a statue of an animal, an umbrella, someone in a high-vis jacket etc. Yes ☐ No ☐
- The dog will sit comfortably while the handler and trainer give the dog a hug*. Yes ☐ No ☐

The safety of the clients and trainers we work with, the general public and above all the safety and welfare of the prospective trainee dog is paramount; it is for these reasons that signs of acute stress or aggression during this test will result in instant failure.

If the trainer is happy that the dog is suitable to begin its Pawsable training journey, the owner can be given the 'In Training' lead-slip.

Upon receipt of the completed assessment form from the trainer (Via email, scan or photo) Pawsable will contact the client who must sign a contract with Pawsable before being eligible to wear the Pawsable jacket.

There will be ongoing informal trainer assessment of all Pawsable assistance dogs throughout their working life to ensure the training standard is maintained and to check on the welfare of the dog and the team.

*Please refer to the Trainer Info Pack to seek clarification around why we ask a dog to accept a hug from a stranger.

Assessment date..... Assessor.....

Pawsable Client Name of Dog.....